Scoring Criteria & Evaluation Instruction Form

Sample RFP Scoring Criteria

The Scoring Criteria is the tool that provides the SFA with the ability to ensure that the FSMC is responsive to their specific requirements. **Scoring Criteria is required in an RFP**. The list below provides suggestions for SFAs to use when selecting their Scoring Criteria. **SFAs should provide a minimum of 3 detailed criteria. All SFAs must use Criteria #1 which is Total Cost.** If an SFA has unique needs or concerns these should be part of the Scoring Criteria. **Only those criteria included in the RFP can be considered when evaluating proposals.**

1. **Total Cost**; the points awarded to the total cost of the contract will be based upon the lowest total cost receiving the most points with decreasing points for each FSMC's higher cost.
   NOTE: Total Cost includes all costs for breakfast, lunch, a la carte meal service and any other Child Nutrition Program meal service (such as Summer Food Service or Child and Adult Care At-Risk Meals) that is operated by the SFA and included in the RFP. Total Cost is NOT solely the FSMC Fee. Scoring must begin at 5 for the lowest Total Cost and continue in descending order.
2. **Guaranteed Return**; the points awarded will be based upon the highest unlimited guaranteed return receiving the most points with decreasing points for each FSMC's lower guaranteed return.
   NOTE: Guarantees cannot be considered when evaluating RFPs unless they are included as a Scoring Criterion. Scoring must begin at 5 for the highest Guarantee and continue in descending order.
3. **Food Quality/Specifications**; FSMC met SFA's requirements for food quality/specifications in its response. **NOTE**: If included as a Scoring Criterion, the specific requirements must be included in the RFP Modifications
4. **FSMC Staffing**: the staffing plan incorporates SFA's minimum staffing and food service director requirements.
   NOTE: If included as a Scoring Criterion, the specific requirements must be included in the RFP Modifications.
5. **Menu**; the FSMC's 21-day cycle menu provides variety and student acceptability.
6. **Promotion of Food Service Program**; the promotional materials and marketing programs each FSMC uses encourages an increase in sales and participation.
7. **Accounting and Reporting Systems**; the FSMC demonstrates that financial reports provided with their monthly billing are straightforward, transparent and unambiguous.
8. **Proposed Meal Count and Financial Targets**; the FSMC's proposed meal counts and income (revenue) should be realistic, practical, and reasonable. If SFA is requiring the FSMC to use Form 372, tab h values, this must be included in the RFP Modifications.
9. **FSMC Transition Plan**; FSMC transition plan meets the needs of the SFA.
   NOTE: Carefully consider all transition plans. Are too many established practices being changed? Are too many staffing changes being made? Consider the number of changes being undertaken. Can they be accomplished?
10. **Nutrition Education, SFA's Nutrition Policy and Healthy Choices**; Nutrition education plans meet the needs of the SFA. The FSMC demonstrates compliance with the SFA's adopted wellness policy.
    NOTE: Consider planned marketing practices, menus and a la carte choices.
11. **Employee Training**; FSMC training plans include: customer service, sanitation and HACCP, culinary skills and Federal and State regulations.
12. **Corporate Capability and Experience**; The FSMC demonstrates the ability to operate a successful school nutrition program.
    NOTE: Some measures can include performance record, years in the industry, client retention, references and financial condition of the FSMC. References to FSMC's geographical location are not allowed.
13. **FSMC Investment**; the FSMC's equipment/investment meets the stated goals the SFA has for its food service program.
    NOTE: If included as a Scoring Criterion, the equipment/investment must be requested in the RFP

RFP Scoring Criteria Chart:

THE CHART BELOW IS FOR ILLUSTRATION PURPOSES ONLY

SFA must complete the Evaluation Criteria and Weighting Factor Percentage sections on Screen 4 in the Electronic Contract Approval System (ECAS). SFA can select from the sample criteria provided above or develop their own. SFA must assign a Weighting Factor Percentage for each criterion and **#1 Total Cost, must have the highest weighting factor percentage**. **SFAs can print and make copies of the Scoring Criteria page that generates from ECAS for use by the evaluators.**

The Criteria Used in Evaluating Proposals The points awarded range from 1 to 5, with 5 being the highest score and 1 being the lowest	Weighting Factor Percentage	Points Score 1 to 5	Total Weighted Score
1. **Total Cost**: points awarded to the cost of the contract (the amount indicated on page 1 of Form 23CR, **Total (Expenses) Cost**) will be based on the lowest total cost receiving the most points with decreasing points for each FSMC's higher cost.			
2.			
3.			
4.			
5.			
6.			
7.			
Weighting Factor Percentage in Column B must total 100% **Total Score is the addition of all totals in Column D**	**100%**		**Total Score**

NOTES for EVALUATION

- **Each Criterion must receive a score ranging from 1-5 points. Each score must be multiplied by the assigned weighting factor percentage to get a weighted score.**
- **When scoring Total Cost, the FSMC with the lowest Total Cost must receive 5 points for that criterion. The next lowest Total Cost amount must receive 4 points, the next lowest 3 points, etc.**
- **Minimum of 3 Evaluators is recommended. Evaluators must complete a Certification of No Conflict**
- **To average the scores for FSMC Proposal Comparison Form (Form #24CR), add all total scores and divide by the number of evaluators.**

NOTE: This form must be completed by <u>each</u> evaluator and kept on file with the School Food Authority (SFA).

Certification of No Conflict

Certification - No Conflict of Interest N.J.A.C. 5:34-4.3(e), (f)

I hereby certify that I have reviewed the conflict of interest standards in the School Ethics Act, as appropriate, and that I do not have a conflict of interest with respect to the evaluation of this proposal. I further certify that I am not engaged in any negotiations or arrangements for prospective employment or association with any of those submitting proposals or their parent or subsidiary organization.

Name of Evaluator: _____

Title: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____